

Meet the pups who ruled the 2026 world dog surfing championships

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The World Dog Surfing Championships took place in Pacifica, California on August 1, 2026. Photo: Haven Daley/AP

Some of the best surfers in the world gathered at a California beach on August 1. But these weren't ordinary surfers. They were dogs! They showed off their talents in the World Dog Surfing Championships. This is the 10th year of the event.

Top Dog of the Day

The top dog of the day was Rippin' Rosie. She is a Labrador retriever from Santa Cruz. Rosie won in the large and extra-large dog category. She also won the stand-up paddleboard contest with her

owner, Steve Drottar. And she received the Spirit of Dog Surfing award.

Drottar has surfed for 40 years. He called Rosie his "dream dog." She jumped onto a paddleboard at a lake when she was only 7 months old. Soon after, she was riding ocean waves. Now, they surf four or five days a week.

"As long as I don't mess up," Drottar said. "Rosie's going to do great."

Iza is a French bulldog. She had a bright pink fin on her life jacket. She won first in the medium dog category. She came in second place overall. She also teamed up with Rusty the Surfing MinPin for the dog-dog tandem contest. This is when two dogs ride the same surfboard. Iza and Rusty won this event.

Pups Teaching Pups

Bradley "Shortboard" Cooper won first place in the small dog group. Carson Surf Dog and Rusty came next. Tina Musto and Jill Nakano are Carson and Bradley's owners. Nakano helps the dogs start. Musto helps them finish.

Their surf-dog family began with a dog they rescued from Hawaii. Their dog, Kihei, learned to surf with Nakano. Kihei later helped teach Carson to surf. Carson then helped Bradley learn. "Dogs kind of mimic each other," Musto said. "They want to do what the big brother's doing."

Now, the dogs surf mostly for fun. The family travels to competitions along the California coast.

Rusty had the best style of the event. The miniature pinscher surfs with leopard- or tiger-patterned fur. He also wears goggles with "angry eyes" and a dinosaur-style fin. His owner, Sophia Sadlowski, said Rusty began surfing at 4 months old. He inspired her to learn at age 59.

"He just honestly trained me," Sadlowski said.

Many dog owners have become good friends through surfing. They meet at beaches and cheer for each other's dogs. They help each other with their dogs.

"Everybody loves their dogs," Drottar said. "They love doing something with their dogs."



Image 1. Iza, a French bulldog, competing in the 2026 World Dog Surfing Championships. Photo: Haven Daley/AP



Image 2. One of the dog competitors at the World Dog Surfing Championships. Photo: Haven Daley/AP

Quiz

- 1 Which question is answered in the section “Top Dog of the Day”?
 - (A) Who won first place in the small dog group?
 - (B) Which dog won the extra-large dog category?
 - (C) Why did Sophia Sadlowski decide to start surfing at age 59?
 - (D) How many World Dog Surfing Championships have there been?

- 2 What did Nakano and Carson do FIRST in the section “Pups Teaching Pups”?
 - (A) They traveled to the California coast.
 - (B) They cheered for other dog owners.
 - (C) They rescued a dog from Hawaii.
 - (D) They taught Kihei how to surf.

- 3 According to the section “Top Dog of the Day,” why did Iza and Rusty team up?
 - (A) to help each other learn to surf
 - (B) to help their owners learn to surf
 - (C) to compete for the award for best style
 - (D) to compete in the dog-dog tandem contest

- 4 Read the section “Pups Teaching Pups.” Which sentence from the section explains why Musto and Nakano’s dogs learned to surf from each other?
 - (A) Carson Surf Dog and Rusty came next.
 - (B) “They want to do what the big brother’s doing.”
 - (C) Now, the dogs surf mostly for fun.
 - (D) “He just honestly trained me,” Sadlowski said.